suspected of complicity in the bombing of a crowd which was celebrating the festival of Dussehra in Lahore. He was quite innocent in this instance. The police, nevertheless, charged him with bomb testing, alleging a protracted plot to free HRA bombers in the Kakori conspiracy case. However, notwithstanding his detention at their hands for a month, the police failed to nail him. He was released after he paid a bond. That left him to continue in his organizational activities. He remained unbowed. He formed the HSRA. The aim was to have an impact on political opinion, and so this party sought openings in the Indian political landscape. The strategic attacks on public official targets, carefully planned and calculated with maximum impact in mind, were suitably called 'Actions'. [4] For all these reasons, it would be remiss not to give a detailed consideration to Bhagat Singh's background. We can start with Ajit Singh, with whom Bhagat Singh was besotted.

Born in Katkar Kalan on 23 February 1881, Ajit Singh, initially worked as a teacher following his graduation from DAV College in Lahore. His incendiary speech, where he denounced the Punjab Colonisation of Land Act for having disposed of the peasantry [5], was such that some in his audience were moved to revolt. When they set alight government buildings, he was arrested with Lala Lajpat Rai and deported for six months to Mandalay. Ajit Singh's actions were portentous, for in the words of Ian Talbot, 'the contradictions in British policy were laid bare by the 1907 disturbances in the canal colonies' and that 'the protests were shocking for the colonial states as they called into question the much vaunted claim that Punjab's stability rested on the loyalty of the rural population'. [6] Ajit Singh's punishment did not placate him. It had the opposite effect. It fortified his militancy, so that in 1909 upon his release he fled to Iran, and from there on to Europe in 1911. As Professor Tim Murphy recounts, he was part of the 'fresh waves of exiles' who were drawn 'towards new revolutionary centres' in 'the cities of the Middle East' where Ajit was 'one more dangerous man on an unsettled frontier between empires,' and where 'there were already close connection between the anarchists of the Mediterranean and the Americas.' [7] His life of intrigue is again captured by